ROLEEDGE · CAREER

Interview Prep Toolkit

Structure, Stories, and Strategies to Win Every Interview

13	10	Print
SECTIONS	EXERCISES	WITH SPACE TO WRITE

> **How to use this guide:** print it, work through it in order, and write in the spaces. Every exercise has room for your answers, and you can print extra copies of any page.

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From **RoleEdge**, founded by Mayank Kapoor, former Manager at Bain & Company and Warwick MBA. Free to use and share.

Why Interview Prep Matters

The best candidates often don't get offers—not because they lack skills, but because they fail to **communicate effectively.** An interview is not just Q&A; it's a **persuasion exercise.**

Employers ask:

- Can this person do the job? (skills)
- Will they fit into the culture? (values)
- Do I want to work with them daily? (presence)

REFLECTION

Think of your last interview. Did you answer to impress or just to respond?

STEP 1

Understand Recruiter Psychology

Recruiters don't have time to dig. They want:

- **Clarity:** Simple, direct answers.
- **Confidence:** No overthinking.
- **Consistency:** Stories aligned across resume, LinkedIn, and answers.

EXERCISE

Write 3 adjectives you want an interviewer to remember about you (e.g., analytical, collaborative, resilient).

1.
2.
3.

STEP 2

Researching the Company & Role

Interviewers expect you to know **why them.**

- Study company strategy (annual reports, press releases).
- Know recent deals/initiatives.
- Understand role expectations (JD keywords).

EXERCISE

Write one reason you want this company specifically—not generic.

STEP 3

Crafting Your Personal Pitch

"Tell me about yourself" = your pitch moment. Keep it **2 minutes, structured, confident.**

Framework: Past → Present → Future.

- Past: Background.
- Present: Current role/strengths.
- Future: Why this role/company.

EXERCISE

Write your 2-minute pitch in 3–4 bullet points.

My pitch	
Past	
Present	
Future	
Why this role	

STEP 4

Mastering Behavioral Questions

Common Qs:

- "Tell me about a time you led a team."
- "Tell me about a conflict."
- "Describe a failure."

Always use STAR (Situation, Task, Action, Result).

EXERCISE

Write 1 STAR story for leadership.

	My leadership story
Situation	
Task	
Action	
Result	

STEP 5

Building a STAR Story Bank

Don't prepare 2–3 stories. Prepare **10–12 across themes**: leadership, problem-solving, teamwork, resilience, innovation.

WORKSHEET

Fill in your story bank: one skill per row and the story that proves it. Aim for at least five.

Skill	My story (a few words to jog your memory)

STEP 6

Handling Strengths & Weaknesses Questions

- **Strengths:** Link to role (e.g., "analytical thinking" for consulting).
- **Weaknesses:** Be honest but show improvement.

Example Weakness: "I used to overanalyze, but I now use structured decision-making to balance speed and accuracy."

EXERCISE

Write 1 strength + 1 weakness aligned to your target role.

	Mine, linked to the role
Strength	
Weakness and how I'm improving	

STEP 7

Preparing for Technical/Role-Specific Questions

Consulting → case studies, profitability math.

Finance → valuation, ratios, DCF.

Tech → coding basics, product thinking.

EXERCISE

Write 3 technical questions you expect in your role.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

STEP 8

Asking Smart Questions to Interviewers

End with strong questions—it shows curiosity and fit.

- "What skills make someone excel in this role here?"
- "How does this team contribute to the company's growth strategy?"

✗ Don't ask about salary at first round.

EXERCISE

Write 2 smart questions you'll ask in your next interview.

1. _____
2. _____

STEP 9

Mock Interviews & Practice Strategies

Practice is the difference. Options:

- Peer practice.
- Mock interviews with mentors.
- AI-based interview tools.

EXERCISE

Schedule 1 mock interview this week.

EXAMPLE

Cracking a consulting interview

An illustrative example. Names and details are representative, not real clients.

Megha practised 40+ cases with peers, refined her STAR stories and rehearsed with a mentor. Result: a business analyst offer from a strategy firm.

Lesson: Consistency beats cramming.

EXAMPLE

Cracking a finance interview

An illustrative example. Names and details are representative, not real clients.

Rohit used targeted resume bullets, practised 50+ finance technical questions and built strong why-finance answers. Result: an investment banking offer.

Lesson: Alignment + confidence win finance interviews.

Common Mistakes and Your 90-Day Plan

Mistakes: Winging answers, ignoring PEI, no prep for technicals.

Fix: Story bank, mocks, research.

Your plan

When	Focus	My actions
Weeks 1–4	Build STAR story bank.	
Weeks 5–8	Practice technicals.	
Weeks 9–12	Mock interviews + refine pitch.	

My notes

NEXT STEP

Want someone to check your work?

Bring this guide to a free call with RoleEdge. We'll go through your answers and help you plan what comes next.

Book a free call at roleedge.com/book